

Teacher Guide & Answer Key

60 SECONDS TO READY

01 ANSWER KEY

QUICK REFERENCE

VOCABULARY

1 – B 2 – D 3 – A 4 – E
5 – C

TRUE OR FALSE

1 F 2 T 3 F 4 T 5 F

LANGUAGE IN CONTEXT

1 shift the blame 2 err on the side of caution
3 turned a blind eye to 4 a drop in the ocean
5 held accountable

TRUE OR FALSE · EVIDENCE

1 there, food “spoils before it reaches market” · 2 blame at home, “perhaps conveniently so” · 3 “donation has limits” · 4 labels “many shoppers misread” · 5 reported as others’ view; the writer warns against shifting blame

CRITICAL THINKING · WHERE DOES THE BLAME LAND?

No correct split. Strong groups judge each defense before scoring: the supermarket’s defense appeals to a shopper choice it helped create; the government’s is accurate but a choice not to act; the food bank’s is valid but raises who should fund storage. Push any group that gives shoppers the largest share to explain how shoppers could have known.

02 TEACHER GUIDE

BEFORE CLASS

AIM

Trace responsibility across a system, test the defenses each actor offers, and defend a policy under challenge.

LENGTH

60–75 minutes.

TIP

Groups will want to blame “the system.” Make them name who, and how much. Opposing groups attack the measure, not the presenters.

EXTENSION

Add a sixth actor to the carrot case. Whose share falls, and why?

03 DISCUSSION NOTES

GUIDE THE TALK

STUDENTS MAY MENTION

date labels · “ugly” produce · multi-buy offers · donation laws · methane & climate · guilt vs. responsibility

FOLLOW-UP QUESTIONS

- Should date labels be scrapped altogether? What might go wrong?
- Why is waste in poorer countries rarely a question of choice?
- Does individual guilt help, or does it distract from bigger changes?

ENCOURAGE THIS LANGUAGE

“That rests on the assumption that...” · “I’d concede that..., but...” · “The flaw in that argument is...”

04 MODEL WRITING

SAMPLE ANSWER

There is a serious case that food waste is, in the end, a matter of personal habit. Households throw away a large share of what they buy, and no law can make anyone plan meals or eat leftovers. Blaming “the system” can become a way to **shift the blame** from choices we make every day.

Yet those choices are shaped long before we make them. Supermarkets reject crooked vegetables, promote offers that encourage overbuying, and print date labels that lead shoppers to **err on the side of caution**. For years, the industry could **turn a blind eye to** losses it rarely paid for itself.

This matters because scale matters. One careful family saves **a drop in the ocean**; one change to a retailer’s specifications saves thousands of tonnes. Laws that **hold** supermarkets **accountable** for what they discard can do what no amount of guilt can.

I therefore largely agree, with one qualification. Food waste is mainly a systemic failure, but systems respond to what people accept. Individual habits will not solve the problem, yet they remain part of the pressure that makes systems change.